

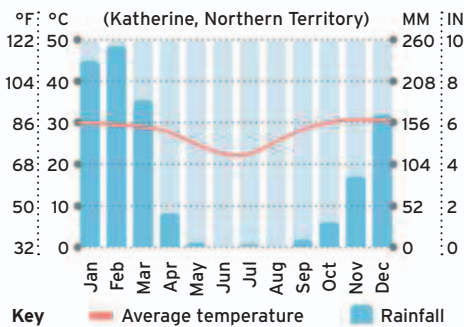
LOCATION

The savannas cover one-fifth of the continent, blending into deserts to the west and forests to the east.



CLIMATE

With steady tropical temperatures and pronounced wet and dry seasons, over four-fifths of rain falls between December and March.



Dingo

Canis lupus dingo

irregular white patches on feet



Dingoes originated thousands of years ago in mainland Asia, where populations still remain. However, interbreeding with domestic dogs has made genetically pure numbers impossible to estimate. Persecuted as a pest, this species is vital to Australia's biodiversity, helping to keep introduced animals such as feral cats, European rabbits, and red foxes under control, which devastate indigenous wildlife.

- 3 ft (0.9 m)
- 21–43 lb (9.5–19.5 kg)
- Vulnerable
- Rabbits, mice, wallabies, birds



SE. Asia, Australia



WATCHING OVER THE PUPS

Only the dominant female in a dingo pack breeds and gives birth, and her pups are cared for by all pack members.

Spectacled hare wallaby

Lagorchestes conspicillatus

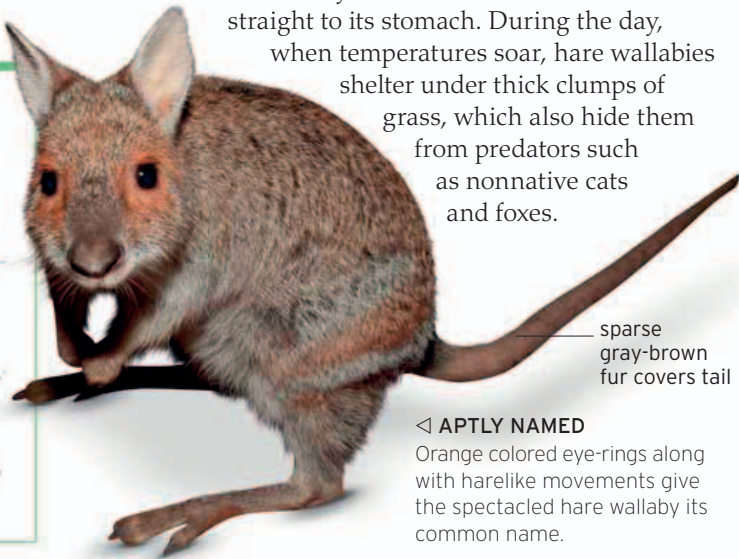
A spectacled hare wallaby is built to conserve water. It has the most efficient kidneys of all mammal species, allowing this nocturnal

marsupial to extract moisture from food, and then produces concentrated urine. It also recycles its own breath moisture straight to its stomach. During the day, when temperatures soar, hare wallabies shelter under thick clumps of grass, which also hide them from predators such as nonnative cats and foxes.

- 16–19 in (40–48 cm)
- 3–10 lb (1.4–4.5 kg)
- Common
- Grass, herbs, fruit



SW. Australia



sparse gray-brown fur covers tail

APTLY NAMED

Orange colored eye-rings along with harelike movements give the spectacled hare wallaby its common name.

500 bird species live here

SEED EATERS

More than half of Australia's 90-plus species of seed-eating birds such as the Gouldian finch frequent the tropical savanna, flying extensively between productive areas. Like so much wildlife, they are at risk from new burning regimes.

GOULDIAN FINCH